Account Panel

What you can do here: View and manage your personal account settings. Change your password, update your project information, and control your privacy and security settings. This is also where you can export your data or delete your account if needed.

Making projects private requires a Private subscription

User account management and project settings.

Onboarding (first sign-up): When you sign up, we ask a few questions including whether you want AI options switched on and active right at the start, and what you want to do first in the app. If you choose an AI-first workflow, AI is switched on automatically. If AI is off, there are no AI services at all (except basic MapCat help); you can change this anytime in Account settings. If AI is on, you get 100 free AI credits per month, and the AI switch is turned on by default; you can turn it off later in Account settings.

AI coding toggle ("AI options switched on and active"): Turn on to use AI; turn off and there are no AI services at all (except basic MapCat help). You can change this anytime in Account settings. When you turn it **on**, a warning modal appears: your data is sent to AI providers when you use AI; it is **not** used to train models; OpenAI (GPT) may retain data for up to 30 days for abuse monitoring; Vertex AI and DashScope do not retain data; see our privacy policy. Credits when on depend on your plan; see AI credits. **Plans without AI** (e.g. Private Manual) can turn on to try with the free allowance (free credits do not stack with paid AI plans).

Where AI runs is a project setting, not a user setting. Each project has an **AI Processing Region** (Project → Edit project → AI Processing Region) with three options: **EU (Belgium, europe-west1)**, **UK (London, europe-west2)**, or **US (Virginia, us-east5)**. New projects default to EU.

When the region is **EU or UK**, the app guarantees every AI call stays in Europe:

- The coding model picker offers the European-resident Geminis only: **Gemini 3.8 Flash** (the coding default), **Gemini 3.5 Flash**, **Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite**, **Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite**, **Gemini 3.1 Pro Preview** and **Gemini 4 Argon**. Every Gemini 3 and 4 model runs in Google's EU multiregion, so processing stays inside the EU. Models with no European route (GPT-5, Qwen) are hidden.
- Any AI request that would process data outside Europe is blocked client-side before it leaves the browser. A notification explains which model or region caused the block and how to fix it.
- Document embeddings (used by RAG and similarity search) automatically route to `europe-west1` (or `europe-west2` for UK), instead of the default `us-central1`.

When the region is **US**, the model picker shows the full list, including GPT-5, Qwen and others. These process your prompts and data outside Europe.

Switching the region for an existing project takes effect immediately — the dropdowns re-render and the gate updates without a reload.

You can change this toggle anytime.

Account Features:

- 👤 project information and settings
- 🔑 Password and security management
- Account deletion and data export
- Subscription and billing information

2FA (beginner guide)

If your organisation asks you to use 2FA, do this in **Account → Two-factor authentication**:

1. Turn on **Require two-factor authentication on sign-in**.
2. Sign out, then sign in again.
3. If asked, scan the QR code in your authenticator app.
4. Enter the 6-digit code to finish setup.

If codes do not work:

- Try a different Causal Map entry in your authenticator (you may have old entries).
- Use **Delete all 2FA factors** in the same card, then sign out/in and set up again.

For strict org policy:

- Click **Require 2FA permanently**.
- This is one-way in the app UI and keeps 2FA locked on for that account.

Image export resolution

Controls resolution for all image capture (map copy/download, bookmarks, pivot/table screenshots, PDF export). Options: 1× (default), 2×, 3×. Resets to 1× on page load. **1× is already very good** for most uses; higher values produce larger files and may hit clipboard limits on large maps.

Subscriptions

Subscriptions List

Users without a subscription are either:

- anonymous (not logged in)
- free (logged in)

An anonymous visitor can open and read a project that has been made public. Nothing else is reachable without an account: editing and AI features both need a signed-in account, as do the prompts, model responses and cost records behind a public project.

Subscriptions (via LemonSqueezy) are available in the Account panel. Monthly and Annual plans are recurring subscriptions: a Monthly plan renews and is charged each month until the subscription manager cancels it.

To manage billing, update payment details, or cancel a subscription, open **Account → Your subscriptions** and click **Manage in LS**. This opens the Lemon Squeezy customer portal. Only the subscription manager/purchaser sees this button; users who only have a seat on someone else's subscription should ask the manager to make billing changes.

Admins can also create **manual subscriptions** (for testing/support). These are stored in the same `subscriptions_purchased` table but do **not** come from Lemon Squeezy.

The subscriptions list uses one row per type (private, pro, team) with seat-count, square radio buttons for monthly/annual and Manual/AI, and a live-updating price (from a JSON price file). Each row includes a text description.

There are three dimensions to the subscriptions,

Manual vs AI,

Type:

- private
- pro
- team

Monthly vs Annual.

AI credits (when you have AI): Free users who opt in get 100 credits/month. Private AI: 1000. Pro AI: 2000. Team, Academic and Corporate: 4000. Credits renew at the start of each month and do not roll over. See Responses Panel for usage. Plans without AI (e.g. Private Manual) can turn on the AI toggle in Account to try with the free 100 credits/month. These figures are the user-facing copy of `subscription-prices.json`, which is the source of truth; update them together.

User can purchase multiples of one or more subs to distribute to colleagues.

Subscriptions Table

The Subscriptions card shows a simple table of the subscriptions where you are the manager or a subscriber, with the manager and subscriber emails. If you manage a subscription, an **Edit** button lets you change who has a seat.

Renewals: your renewal date updates automatically whenever you open or refresh the app while signed in. Access continues for 3 days past a renewal date while the payment goes through.

Warnings in the app: when a plan paid by invoice ends within 14 days, or a card renewal has not reached us by its due date, a yellow badge at the top of the app says when access ends, and a notification repeats it once a day.

Reminder emails: a plan paid by invoice or set up for a fixed term does not renew by itself, so we also email you 14 days and 1 day before it ends.

Private projects and subscription expiry

The paid value is privacy: a **private** project is one that only you, and the people you invite, can see. Keeping a project private needs an active paid plan.

On the free plan, projects are **public**: anyone with the link can view them. You cannot make a project private without a paid plan.

On a paid plan that includes private projects (Private, Pro, Team and similar), you can make projects **private** and work on them privately.

If your paid plan expires, your private projects cannot be opened, viewed or edited, until you do one of these:

- **Renew** your plan: the projects stay private and open normally again, or
- **Make a project public:** you can do this without a plan, behind a confirmation. After that anyone can view it, and you can open and edit it again.

Your private projects are never published for you. Turning a project public is always your own explicit choice.

When you allocate seats, the email box pre-fills your own email in the first slot and tells you how many seats are left, or if you have added too many emails.